

Collection Operations Standard, COS 2019

Statistics Office of Averly. Standard for the follow up of business survey returns. In force from 1 January 2020 for the Business Activity Survey and applied to every schedule adopted since.

1. Purpose

The follow up schedule sets, for each stratum, the elapsed time after dispatch at which the first reminder and the escalation are issued. The Board adopts one schedule for each calendar year on the basis of the latest complete reference year.

2. Elapsed time

2.1 The elapsed time of a return is the number of whole minutes from the dispatch timestamp of the questionnaire to the receipt timestamp of the return, any fraction of a minute discarded. 2.2 A return is counted in the reference year of its receipt timestamp. 2.3 Elapsed times are compiled by stratum on the basis used for the Collection Performance Bulletin.

3. Committed shares

The committed shares are one half (first reminder) and nine tenths (escalation), written p50 and p90.

4. Boundary rule

4.1 For a share a/b and a stratum population of n elapsed times sorted in ascending order, the boundary is the elapsed time at rank ceiling of a multiplied by n divided by b . No interpolation between ranks is made. 4.2 The boundary is rounded up to the next multiple of 10 minutes. A boundary already on a multiple of 10 is unchanged. 4.3 The reminder day implied by a boundary is the boundary divided by 1,440 rounded up to the next whole day. 4.4 The survey wide boundary is taken on the pooled population of all strata by the same rule.

5. Population for the schedule

The schedule for a calendar year is compiled from the returns of the latest complete reference year. The schedule for 2026 is compiled from the returns received in 2025.

6. Reproduction of published means

6.1 A schedule may be put to the Board only if the compilation on which it rests reproduces, to the minute, every mean elapsed time published in the Collection Performance Bulletin for the four reference years preceding the schedule population. 6.2 A compilation that fails to reproduce any published mean is not admissible, and no schedule may be adopted from it, whatever the size of the difference. 6.3 Where no admissible compilation can be found, the matter is reported to the Board; the standing schedule is not carried forward by default.

7. Movement against the standing schedule

The note to the Board states, for each stratum and share, the movement of the new boundary against the standing schedule in per cent to one decimal place, and names the stratum that moves furthest.